

GET THE BEST DEALS

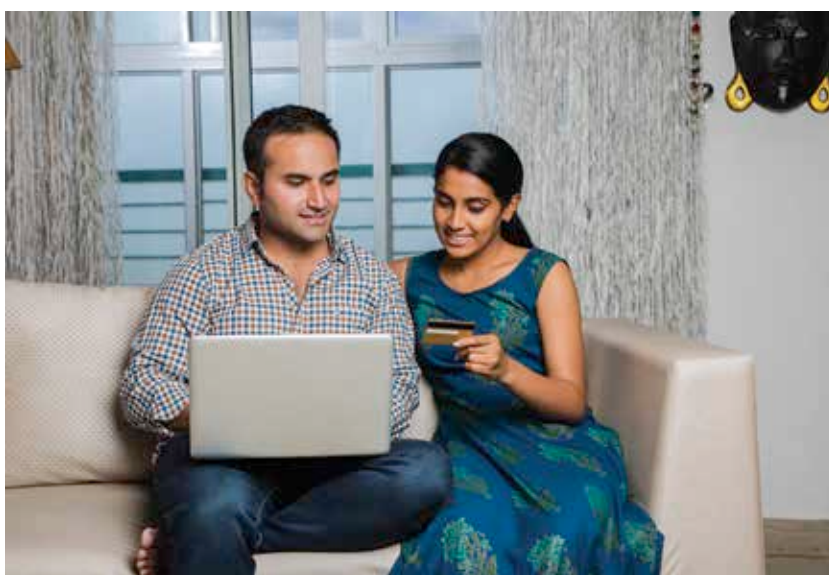
SHOP SMART AND YOU CAN SAVE A PRETTY PENNY

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PLAN AHEAD

This is one of the simplest ways to save money, yet too few people seem to do it. It is particularly helpful when buying a smartphone. This is a product category where you are required to make periodic purchases. The first step is to familiarise yourself with the release cycles of devices. The iPhones have a tick-tock cycle, but may be moving to a tick-tick-tock cycle. The OnePlus releases have the T models and a half yearly cycle. Before deciding on a model, decide on the next device that you are going to invest in. If you are not willing or unable to lock in on a particular device, at least decide the time frame and budget for the subsequent purchase.

Doing this will allow you to make a more informed decision for the current device, gives you an upgrade path that makes the most sense, and allows you to prepare yourself for the purchase. Next, always buy a device in the last three months of the year. Towards the end of the year, most major manufacturers have announced their new products. Between October to December are also when most of the sales take place, and where you can get the best prices for your devices. For example, if you decide to purchase one of the 2020 iPhones in 2021, you can opt in for the iPhone XR this year. It just received a ₹10K price drop, after the release of 2019 phones. For the high-end phones, it is okay to invest in a device that is a year old, if it is available for much cheaper. Planning ahead



allows you to jump on the opportunity of getting a device for cheap if a friend or relative is travelling abroad.

Once you have invested in a device, make sure that it lasts for as long as you wanted. Between 2-4 years is an ideal time period that you should be aiming for. During this time, take care of your device. For Android devices, root it and get a custom ROM. The lean

ROM options remove most of the extra bloatware from your device. Custom ROMs also let you underclock your device if it is running too hot. Custom ROMs can help you extend the lifetime of the product after support from the manufacturers has ceased. One of the most important things is to watch the battery recharge cycles. Charge the device to the max, but don't leave it plugged in beyond 100 percent. Then, let it drain completely. This means that your battery will last longer, and the phone will require less maintenance. If you are leaving your phone for charging overnight, it is a good idea to invest in a charging adapter with a timer. These devices cut off power supply after a particular preset amount of time has passed. Also invest in a case, a screen protector, and get insurance



A charging adapter with a timer